[METRIC]

A-A-873B
October 8, 1993
SUPERSEDING
A-A-873A
November 30, 1990

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

STAPLER, PAPER FASTENING, HEAVY DUTY

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE. This description covers heavy duty desk top staplers which are used for clinching paper.

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS:

A. Construction. The stapler shall be designed for desk top operation and shall accommodate a staple strip of "heavy-duty" preformed staples in accordance with CID A-A-2707. The stapler shall have a throat depth of not less than 8.3 cm (3.25"). The feeding mechanism shall operate automatically so as to feed an individual, new staple beneath the plunger after each stapling operation. The stapler shall have a "power lever" or "strong arm" inherent to the design. The stapler shall be permanently marked with the name or trademark of the manufacturer. Unless otherwise specified, the color of the stapler shall be at the option of the supplier. Resilient pads shall be fitted to the base to protect desk tops. The stapler shall be able to consistently form a standard clinch, as specified below:

Standard Clinch. The standard clinch is represented by a staple driven home through two sheets of paper. Each leg shall be folded under so the tips of each leg face inward towards each other. Further, each tip shall be in a downward slope back toward reentering the paper.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document, should be sent to: General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, 26 Federal Plaza, New York N.Y. 10278 ATTN: Engineering Branch (2FYEE).

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B. Materials. Staple drivers shall be made of spring steel containing not less than 0.6% carbon, and hardened equally over the whole length to an equivalent of not less than 48HRC, when tested as specified in 3.C.(2). Anvils shall be made of hardened throughout or case hardened steel with thickness of the case not less than 0.20 mm (0.008"), and shall be not less than 85 (15-N-85) Rockwell Superficial when tested as specified in 3.C.(2). Springs shall be made of spring steel containing not less than 0.6% carbon and be heat treated to sufficient hardness to provide the necessary spring properties for satisfactory functioning of the staplers. Hinge pins, follow block, bearings, plungers and channels shall be made from a commercially acceptable corrosion resistant metal. Individual parts shall be anodized, plated, painted, or subjected to a bluing process, whichever is commercially appropriate for the specific function of the part. The striking surface of the handles shall be made of suitable material for the purpose intended. If plastic material or hard rubber is used, it shall have toughness, resiliency, and the ability to withstand shock. Contractor shall provide a certificate of compliance for corrosion resistance on all metal parts used in the construction of the stapler upon request by the Government.

C. Performance Test. The stapler shall not exhibit any evidence of jamming or malfunction, when tested as specified in 3.C.(1). After each stapling operation, the base of the vertical chute shall automatically return to its proper position which shall be 12.7 - 19.1 mm (0.50 - 0.75)" above the top of the anvil. After testing, the stapler shall not exhibit evidence of deformity, including, but not limited to cracking, bending, loosened parts, warping, or visible stress marks, or any type of wear which affects operation.

D. Workmanship: The frame and all movable parts (whether metal or plastic) shall be free of defects, including, but not limited to, burrs, niches, dents, rough or sharp edges, scratches, blisters, crinkling, imbedded foreign matter, discoloration or any other imperfections which might impair serviceability and adversely affect the appearance, or which might constitute a personal hazard to the user. Any fasteners, rivets or pins used in the assembly of the stapler shall be set in accordance with normal commercial practice and shall exhibit a firmly tightened, flush seating. The follow-block, driver, or other moving parts shall not exhibit any sticking or binding when used in the normal stapling mode.

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3. QUALITY ASSURANCE:

A. Responsibility for Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this Commercial Item Description, where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

B. Sampling. Samples shall be selected for inspection in accordance with MIL-STD-105, using the plans described in Table I. A lot shall consist of a number of sample units manufactured by the same process from the same components at the same time. Random samples shall be drawn from each lot for the end item inspection. Unless otherwise specified, each lot shall be tested.

TABLE I

Inspection Type	AQL (%) Defective	Inspection Level	Sample Unit	Requirement Paragraph/s
Construction Materials & Workmanship	4.0	S-3	One stapler	2.A 2.B 2.D
Testing	4.0	S-1	One stapler	2.C
Packaging Packing & Marking	4.0	S-2	One shipping container	5

C. Testing.

(1). Performance Test. Using bond paper with a basis weight of 75 g/m^2 (20-lb based on 17" x 22" - 500 sheets), this test shall demonstrate the capability of each stapler to consistently clinch 20 sheets using Size A staples; 60 sheets using Size B staples; and 100 sheets using Size C staples. All the staples used for testing shall conform to CID A-A-2707. For each staple size, the stapling operation shall be done 50 times. Each stapler shall therefore perform a total of 150 operations. For each 150 stapling operations, at least 135 operations shall provide a standard clinch and conform to the requirements set in paragraph 2.C. herein.

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(2). Hardness Test. Rockwell hardness shall be tested in accordance with ASTM E 18. Certificate of compliance is acceptable.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS: The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance Paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation.

5. PACKAGING, PACKING AND MARKING... Shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

6. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS: The issue of the referenced documents in effect on the date of the solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

A. Federal Regulations:

Federal Acquisition Regulation. Paragraph 23.403

Copies of the U. S. Code may be obtained through the Congressional Sales Office, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

B. Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

Available from: Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094, or as directed by the contracting officer.

C. Commercial Item Description:

A-A-2707, Staples, Heavy Duty, Paper Fastening

Single copies of this Commercial Item Description, or other Commercial Item Descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston; New York; Philadelphia; Washington, D.C.; Atlanta; Chicago; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth; Houston: Denver; Los Angeles; San Francisco; and Auburn, WA.

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D. ASTM References:

ASTM E 18 - Standard Test Methods for Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials.

Available from: ASTM., 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

7. NOTES: Purchasers shall specify the following in the contract or purchase order:

(1) Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description.
(2) Color of the stapler. (If specific color is required).
(3) Unit of issue and quantity.
(4) Arrangements for inspections and inspection facilities. (If different than provisions under Quality Assurance.)
(5) Packaging, packing and marking required.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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